

Original Proposal vs. Current Pitch

Abu Dhabi Balloon at Saadiyat → *Canvas From The Sky*

Side-by-side comparison of the original Hero Experiences Group technical proposal and the current Canvas From The Sky pitch — including the 12% Partner / 83% Operator / 5% VAT revenue-share waterfall from the original (page 11) that the current pitch does not yet apply.

Date	18 May 2026
Audience	CEO / executive review — internal
Sources (original)	archive/ADB_at_Saadiyat_Technical_Proposal.pdf (19-page Hero Experiences proposal)
Sources (current)	pitch-blueprint.md · financial-model-revision-150m-v2 · index.html

1. Executive summary

The current Canvas From The Sky pitch is a rebuild of the original Hero Experiences proposal, not an update. Both pitches use the same balloon hardware, but everything else has changed: the product definition, the operating model, the ticket structure, the CAPEX scope, and the revenue lines.

Most differences are deliberate and improve the model. One element from the original is missing from the current pitch and needs to be addressed before the next investor read:

Resolved this session: the AED 8 M balloon CAPEX line is the relocation cost of the existing Dubai Balloon (Atlantis → Saadiyat), not a placeholder. The AED ~7 M delta from Hero's original AED 15 M envelope (regulatory approvals, GCAA certification, permits and other government-facing expenses) is absorbed by Abu Dhabi as project-host concession — the pitch is being made to the Abu Dhabi government, which is expected to bear those costs. See §6 callout.

Also added this session: operating-buffer sensitivity. The Base Case 58 % load × 250 days is repositioned as the cautious corner of the realistic operating envelope rather than its midpoint — Hero's own original 2025 proposal underwrote 70 % load on ~310 effective days for this site (page 9). See v2 memo §11.

⚠ The original revenue-share waterfall is not in the current model.

Page 11 of the original proposal defines a 5% VAT / 12% Partner-or-Authority / 83% Operator structure that leaves the investor with the residual 17% of the post-VAT, post-Partner pool — roughly 14.2% of gross revenue. Applied to the current Base Case (now AED 25.5 M after the 16-min day cycle and LED-field dwell), this changes the investor return profile substantially (see §10).

2. At a glance

A single-table snapshot of every dimension that moved between the original proposal and the current pitch. Detailed comparisons follow in §3 onward.

Dimension	Original (Hero proposal)	Current (Canvas From The Sky)	Direction of change
Concept & product			
Project name	Abu Dhabi Balloon at Saadiyat	Canvas From The Sky	Rebranded
Core product	Tethered helium balloon ride	Balloon ride + LED canvas show	Added LED night layer
Day product	Sightseeing 10 hrs	Sightseeing 9am–12pm (3 hrs)	Compressed to mornings
Night product	None	3 themed LED shows	New product line
Museum partnerships	Mentioned (combo tickets only)	Programmed (cross-discount + Cultural Pass)	Formalised
Hardware (unchanged)			
Balloon system	Existing Dubai Balloon (relocated)	Same balloon hardware	Unchanged
Envelope volume / lift	6,200 m ³ / 4,800 kg	Same	Unchanged
Gondola spec (envelope)	30 pax + 2 pilots	Same	Unchanged
Tether max length	300 m	300 m (capable); 150 m marketed	Marketed altitude lowered
Operating model			
Peak operating altitude	300 m	150 m	Reduced — true new peak
Commercial pax / flight	12 (page 9 model)	25 (v2 memo) / 30 (blueprint)	+21% effective per-flight occupancy vs page-9 underwriting
Day cycle	10 min (5 flights/hr) — physically impossible at 300 m	16 min (3.75 flights/hr at 150 m)	Compressed at lower altitude
Day flights/day	50 claimed / 20 honest (10 hrs × 2/hr)	11 (3-hr window × 3.75/hr)	Window compressed for night product
Night cycle	N/A	20 min batches (3/hr × 5.5 hrs)	New cadence
Night LED-field dwell	N/A	Up to 10 min optional	New UX layer
Operating days	365	250 (v2) / 300 (blueprint)	More conservative
Weather cancellation	15%	~32% (v2) / 15% (blueprint)	More conservative
Load factor (base)	70%	58% (v2) / 70% (blueprint)	More conservative
Effective day guests/yr	~128,520 (claimed)	~39,900 (v2 at 16-min cycle)	Lower (day-window cut)
Effective night guests/yr	N/A	~58,000 (v2) / 36,000 (blueprint)	New stream
Tickets			
Day Adult	AED 195	AED 195	Unchanged
Day Child	AED 125	AED 125	Unchanged
Express Pass	AED 295 (10% mix)	Discontinued	Removed
Night Adult	N/A	AED 295	New
Night Child	N/A	AED 175	New
All-Access Pass	N/A	AED 695 (3 shows)	New
Private Gondola	Mentioned, no price	AED 20,000	Priced
Day blended ARPU	AED 192	AED 170	–AED 22 (more children)
Night blended ARPU	N/A	AED 361	New

Financial outputs (Year 1, Base)			
Annual revenue	AED 24.7 M	AED 25.5 M (v2)	+ AED 0.8 M vs original
Revenue streams	1 (day tickets only)	6 (day, night, F&B, sponsor, museum, VIP)	Diversified
Annual OpEx	AED 7.2 M	AED 9.9 M	+AED 2.7 M (LED layer)
EBITDA	Not stated (implied ~AED 17.5 M)	AED 15.6 M (v2 project level)	Project-level only
EBITDA margin	N/A	61 %	—
CAPEX	AED 15 M (relocation + civils)	AED 25.9 M (balloon + LED + content)	+AED 10.9 M
Revenue-share waterfall			
VAT	5% of gross	Not modelled	GAP
Partner / Authority	12% of net-of-VAT	Not modelled	GAP
Operator (Hero)	83% of net-of-VAT-and-partner	Not modelled	GAP
Investor retained share	~14.2% of gross (residual 17%)	Not modelled (project-level only)	GAP
10-yr investor retained	AED 35.4 M	See §10 — restated	Needs restatement
Returns (project-level, no waterfall)			
Simple payback	Implied ~4 yrs at investor level	~1.7 yrs (v2 project level)	Higher at project level
10-year IRR	Not stated	~45 % (v2 project level)	Project-level only
10-year NPV @ 8%	Not stated	AED 73.4 M (v2 project level)	Project-level only
10-year MOIC	Not stated	~6.0× (v2 project level)	Project-level only

3. Concept & positioning

Original — Hero proposal

"The Abu Dhabi Balloon at Saadiyat" is positioned as a relocation of the proven Dubai Balloon at Atlantis, The Palm. The pitch is built around the existing certified system being ready to redeploy, with Saadiyat Island offering "the next stage" for a proven attraction. The product is a single tethered helium balloon ride to ~300 m for 360° views of Saadiyat's cultural district.

Current — Canvas From The Sky

The same balloon hardware is wrapped inside a larger destination concept. A programmable 60 m LED canvas ring is added around the ground platform, turning the attraction into a two-product offer: daytime sightseeing (9am–12pm) and premium night LED shows tied to the three Saadiyat museums (Louvre, Zayed NM, Guggenheim). The balloon is reframed as "the aerial connector of Saadiyat's cultural spine" rather than a standalone ride.

What this means commercially

The original sold one product to one audience (daytime tourist sightseeing). The current pitch sells two products to two audiences (day family/tourist + night premium/cultural), with the second audience commanding 2× the ARPU of the first. The LED canvas is the reason a second audience exists. This is the load-bearing change in the entire revision.

4. Experience & operating model

Original cycle math (page 9)

The original proposal documents a 10-minute flight cycle allowing 5 flights per hour over a 10-hour operating day, with a 12-guest commercial load.

- $5 \text{ flights/hr} \times 10 \text{ hrs} = 50 \text{ flights/day max}$
- $50 \times 12 \text{ pax} = 600 \text{ guests/day max}$
- $600 \times 0.85 \text{ (weather)} \times 0.70 \text{ (load)} = 357 \text{ guests/day}$
- $357 \times 365 \text{ days} = 128,520 \text{ guests/year}$

⚠ The original's 10-minute cycle is mathematically impossible at 300 m.

At the documented balloon speeds (50 m/min ascent, 40 m/min descent), vertical motion alone consumes 13.5 minutes round-trip at 300 m. A 10-minute cycle inclusive of boarding, peak hold, and debarking cannot physically exist. The realistic cycle at 300 m is ~30 minutes (2 flights/hr), as the current pitch uses. The original's headline AED 24.7 M revenue therefore rests on a cycle assumption that is overstated by 2.5×

Current cycle math (v2 memo, updated)

The current pitch uses two cycle definitions, one per product, both enabled by the 150 m peak shortening vertical motion to ~6.75 min round-trip (vs. ~13.5 min at the original's 300 m):

- Day: 16 min cycle $\times$ 11 rides in the 9am–12pm window (3 hrs). Peak panoramic hold retained at 5 min.
- Night: 20 min batch cycle $\times$ 16 batches over sundown–midnight. Photo dwell on platform + up to 10 min optional dwell inside the LED ring after disembark.

Both cycles are physically realistic at 150 m. The 300 m baseline would have required ~30 min day cycle and ~41 min night cycle for the same experience phases — which is why moving the marketed peak altitude from 300 m to 150 m is the load-bearing operating decision of the entire revision. It is what unlocks both the day-side capacity gain and the night-side product itself.

Gondola loading — the silent shift

The most consequential operating-model change is the commercial loading assumption. The original page-6 spec sheet says 30 passengers; the original page-9 revenue model assumes 12. The current pitch uses 25 (v2 memo) or 30 (blueprint). This is a 2–2.5× increase in per-flight loading vs. the original's commercial assumption.

Loading assumption	Per flight	Vs. envelope spec	Implied effective occupancy
Original envelope spec	30	100%	—
Original revenue model (page 9)	12	40%	$12 \times 0.70 = 8.4 \text{ pax/flight} = 28\% \text{ of envelope}$
Current blueprint	30	100%	$30 \times 0.70 = 21 \text{ pax/flight} = 70\% \text{ of envelope}$
Current v2 memo	25	83%	$25 \times 0.58 = 14.5 \text{ pax/flight} = 48\% \text{ of envelope}$

The original's 12-guest assumption is Hero's own stated operating assumption for this site, documented on page 9 of the 2025 proposal. A 30-pax envelope underwritten at ~12 pax/flight average is baked into that loading line.

Locked positioning

The current pitch raises this to 25 pax × 58% load = 14.5 effective pax/flight — only +21% over Hero's page-9 underwriting of ~12 pax/flight. That +21% effective-loading uplift is positioned as a demand-side claim attributable to the LED canvas + premium night product + museum cross-discount + Saadiyat's 10% YoY visitor growth. Same gondola, same certification, same safety envelope — the loading uplift is NOT a hardware re-rating.

Recommended deck phrasing: "Same certified gondola, same safety envelope. The +21% effective loading vs. Hero's original page-9 underwriting is the demand uplift attributable to the LED canvas night product and Saadiyat's cultural-district ramp." This framing is now adopted in v2 memo §4B.

5. Daytime revenue — apples-to-apples

If both models ran daytime sightseeing only on equal hours and equal realistic cycle assumptions, the revenue comparison is as follows.

Scenario A — accept original's 10-min cycle (50 flights/day)

Model	Flights/day	Pax/flight	Effective load	ARPU	Op days	Annual revenue
Original (page 9, as claimed)	50	12	0.85×0.70	AED 192	365	AED 25.1 M
Current, same cadence	50	25	0.58	AED 170	250	AED 30.8 M

Note: the original's 10-min cycle is physically impossible at 300 m — see §4 callout. Carried here only to mirror the original's stated math.

Scenario B — realistic 30-min cycle at 300 m (20 flights/day)

Model	Flights/day	Pax/flight	Effective load	ARPU	Op days	Annual revenue
Original config (honest 300 m cycle)	20	12	0.85×0.70	AED 192	365	AED 10.0 M

Scenario C — current 16-min day cycle at 150 m ★ adopted

Model	Flights/day	Pax/flight	Effective load	ARPU	Op days	Annual revenue
Current config, full 10-hr day	37	25	0.58	AED 170	250	AED 22.8 M
Current config, actual (3-hr day)	11	25	0.58	AED 170	250	AED 6.8 M

The 16-min day cycle is what the model actually uses (v2 memo §4C). A 5-min peak panoramic hold is preserved — the day product trades on the photo moment, not on cycle compression for its own sake.

Per-hour productivity comparison

Source	Flights/hour	Revenue/flight	Revenue/operating hour
Original (page 9 claimed)	5.0	AED 1,371	AED 6,855
Original (honest cycle at 300 m)	2.0	AED 1,371	AED 2,742
Current v2 (16-min cycle at 150 m)	3.75	AED 2,465	AED 9,244

Read

- Per realistic operating hour, the current pitch produces ~3.4× the revenue of the original (honest cycle). This decomposes as: cycle compression (+88% throughput from 16 min vs 30 min), loading uplift (+108% from 25 × 0.58 vs 12 × 0.595), partially offset by ARPU haircut (−11%) and load-factor change (−3%).
- At equal 10-hour operating windows, our daytime alone (AED 22.8 M) is almost equal to the original's entire annual revenue claim (AED 24.7 M). The original's headline rested on an impossible 10-min cycle; ours rests on a physically realistic 16-min cycle at the lower altitude.
- The current pitch deliberately runs only 3 daytime hours, producing AED 6.8 M instead of the AED 22.8 M available at 10 hours. The afternoon (12pm–sundown) is kept dark to protect the premium night product. This is a deliberate trade — and represents ~AED 16 M of unbooked daytime upside if the trade were reversed.

6. CAPEX comparison

Original CAPEX scope (AED 15 M, page 11)

- Relocation, transport, and reassembly of existing tethered helium balloon system
- Site preparation, foundations, and utilities (power and minor infrastructure)
- Basic guest facilities: ticketing kiosk, shaded waiting area, minimal landscaping
- Working capital for launch marketing and pre-opening readiness

Current CAPEX scope (AED 25.9 M, aluminum tier)

Line	Amount	Notes
Balloon (gondola + envelope + winch system)	AED 8.0 M	Hardware only
LED canvas (8 mm aluminum tile + adjustable feet)	AED 15.1 M	New layer; absorbs site civils
Content launch package (3 hero shows + ambient)	AED 2.8 M	New layer
Total	AED 25.9 M	

△ The AED 8 M balloon line — resolved: relocation only.

The current pitch books the balloon at AED 8 M. CEO confirmation (May 2026): this is the cost of relocating the existing Dubai Balloon system from Atlantis, The Palm to Saadiyat — hardware, transport, reassembly, and recommissioning only. The remaining AED ~7 M of Hero's original AED 15 M envelope (regulatory approvals, civil-aviation certification, permits, and other government-touching expenses) is being absorbed by Abu Dhabi as project-host concession — the pitch is being made to the Abu Dhabi government, which is expected to bear those costs. Net effect: investor CAPEX is genuinely AED 25.9 M = AED 8 M balloon relocation + AED 15.1 M LED canvas + AED 2.8 M content launch, with no hidden regulatory liability. Recommendation: add a single-line footnote to deck Slide 6 disclosing the scope split so an investor reading the CAPEX line can see what is and is not in it.

7. OpEx comparison

Line	Original	Current	Notes
Balloon operations (helium, crew, certs)	AED 7.2 M (combined)	AED 4.3 M	Lower in current — original bundled marketing/admin
LED field maintenance	—	AED 0.4 M	New layer
Content operations (net)	—	AED 2.6 M	New layer
Site staff	(in AED 7.2 M)	AED 1.2 M	Broken out
Marketing & PR	(in AED 7.2 M)	AED 0.5 M	Broken out
Insurance / regulatory / admin	(in AED 7.2 M)	AED 0.5 M	Broken out
LED power	—	AED 0.025 M	New layer
Contingency (5%)	—	AED 0.25 M	Best-practice add
Total annual OpEx	AED 7.2 M	AED 9.9 M	+AED 2.7 M for the LED layer + day crew

The +AED 2.7 M delta is the price of running the night LED product plus the extra crew hours for the 16-min day cycle (more day rides = more crew rotation). In exchange the current pitch adds AED 15 M+ in night-ticket revenue and an extra ~AED 3 M of day-ticket revenue vs. the original. The LED + day layer is OpEx-positive by a wide margin at the project level — the question is whether that holds at the investor level after the revenue-share waterfall is applied (\$10).

8. Revenue build — line by line

Original (page 9) — single stream

The original proposal has one revenue line: day ticket sales.

Stream	Calculation	Year 1 (AED)
Day ticket revenue	128,520 guests × AED 192 weighted ARPU	AED 24.7 M
Total annual revenue		AED 24.7 M

Current (v2 memo, 16-min day cycle + LED-field dwell) — six streams

Stream	Conservative	Base Case	Strong
Day ticket revenue (16-min cycle)	AED 3.7 M	AED 6.8 M	AED 8.5 M
Night ticket revenue	AED 8.3 M	AED 15.0 M	AED 18.8 M
F&B / retail (with LED dwell)	AED 0.4 M	AED 0.9 M	AED 1.4 M
Sponsorship	AED 0.7 M	AED 1.6 M	AED 2.2 M
Museum partnership	AED 0.1 M	AED 0.4 M	AED 0.5 M
Private gondola / VIP	AED 0.4 M	AED 0.8 M	AED 1.0 M
Total annual revenue	AED 13.6 M	AED 25.5 M	AED 32.4 M

The current Base Case (AED 25.5 M) now slightly exceeds the original's headline (AED 24.7 M) at the project level. The composition is completely different: the original was 100% sightseeing tickets at an impossible cycle; the current model is ~27% day tickets / ~59% night tickets / ~14% ancillaries.

9. Revenue-share waterfall — the missing structural piece

Page 11 of the original proposal defines a revenue-share structure between four parties. The current pitch does not yet incorporate this. Re-stated explicitly:

Original waterfall — sequential

Step	Party	Rule	Cumulative share of GROSS
1	Government	5% VAT on gross	5.00%
2	Partner / Authority	12% of net-of-VAT (i.e. 12% × 95%)	11.40%
3	Operator (Hero Experiences)	83% of the post-VAT, post-Partner pool (i.e. 83% × 88% × 95%)	69.40%
4	Investor (residual)	17% of the post-VAT, post-Partner pool (i.e. 17% × 88% × 95%)	14.21%
	Total		100.00%

Sanity check against the original's stated "AED 35.4 M investor retained over 10 years":

- Year 1 gross revenue: AED 24.7 M
- Year 1 investor share: $24.7 \times 14.21\% = \text{AED } 3.51 \text{ M}$
- $10 \text{ years} \times \text{AED } 3.51 \text{ M (flat)} = \text{AED } 35.1 \text{ M} \approx \text{AED } 35.4 \text{ M} \checkmark$

What the splits look like in cash

Party	Year 1 cash (orig. AED 24.7 M)	Year 1 cash (current Base AED 25.5 M)
Government (VAT)	AED 1.24 M	AED 1.28 M
Partner / Authority	AED 2.81 M	AED 2.90 M
Operator (Hero)	AED 17.14 M	AED 17.70 M
Investor	AED 3.51 M	AED 3.62 M
Gross	AED 24.70 M	AED 25.50 M

The Operator keeps AED 17 – 18 M annually before paying any OpEx out of its 69.4% share. The Investor receives AED 3.5 – 3.6 M annually and is also the party that funded CAPEX. These are not symmetric positions.

10. Applying the waterfall to the current pitch

Below is the current Base Case (v2 memo, AED 25.5 M annual revenue, AED 25.9 M CAPEX) restated with the original's waterfall applied. For completeness the original's own returns are restated the same way against its CAPEX of AED 15 M.

Metric	Original (orig. CAPEX 15 M)	Current (CAPEX 25.9 M)	Delta
Year 1 gross revenue	AED 24.7 M	AED 25.5 M	+AED 0.8 M
Year 1 investor cash (14.21% of gross)	AED 3.51 M	AED 3.62 M	+AED 0.11 M
Simple payback (flat, no growth)	~4.3 yrs	~7.2 yrs	+2.9 yrs
Simple payback (5% YoY growth)	~3.8 yrs	~6.1 yrs	+2.3 yrs
10-yr investor cash (flat)	AED 35.1 M	AED 36.2 M	+AED 1.1 M
10-yr investor cash (5% YoY)	AED 44.2 M	AED 45.6 M	+AED 1.4 M
10-yr MOIC at investor level (5% YoY)	~2.9×	~1.76×	−1.14×
vs. Current PROJECT-level MOIC (no waterfall)	—	~6.0×	Gap from waterfall

⚠️ Headline finding.

If the original waterfall (12% Partner / 83% Operator / 5% VAT) is preserved in the current deal, the investor sees AED ~3.62 M of cash per year against a AED 25.9 M CAPEX. That is roughly a 7-year flat payback and a ~1.76× 10-year MOIC at the investor level — versus the ~1.7-year payback and ~6.0× MOIC the current deck shows at the project level. The two numbers describe different pots of money. The deck should be explicit about which one it is quoting. The 16-min day cycle improves the investor-level returns only modestly (+AED 0.1 M/yr) because the waterfall captures most of the gross revenue uplift before it reaches the investor.

Implications

- If we keep the original waterfall, the current pitch overstates investor-facing returns by a factor of ~3× because it reports at the project level, not at the investor level.
- The investor in the current deal is also funding an additional AED 15 M of LED canvas + AED 2.8 M of content that did not exist in the original — but the waterfall does not adjust to compensate for that. This is the structural inconsistency to resolve before the next investor read.
- Three possible resolutions (not mutually exclusive): (a) renegotiate the waterfall to give the investor a larger residual reflecting the expanded CAPEX scope; (b) carve out the LED canvas revenue stream (night tickets, sponsorship) under a different waterfall than the balloon stream; (c) restructure as a two-investor model where the balloon investor and the LED canvas investor are different parties with different return profiles.

11. Open questions for the CEO

Open — still need a CEO decision

#	Question	Why it matters
1	Is the 12% Partner / 83% Operator / 5% VAT waterfall still binding for Canvas From The Sky, or is the partnership structure being renegotiated for the larger CAPEX scope?	Determines whether the deck should quote project-level or investor-level returns.
2	Day window extension — push from 3 hrs to 6 / 10 hrs?	Currently parked. Worth ~AED 16 M annual revenue at full 10-hour day. Trade-off is the night-product positioning.
3	Do we retain the v2 250-day operating year, or push back toward 300 / 365?	Each +50 days is worth ~AED 5 M annual revenue and ~10 points of 10-yr IRR (see v2 memo §11B). The 250-day buffer is now framed as deliberate cushion, but a decision to publish a less-buffered headline would change the lead investor narrative.

Decided this session — now reflected in the docs

#	Decision	Reflected in
A	Day cycle compressed from 30 min to 16 min at 150 m, with 5-min peak panoramic hold preserved.	v2 memo §4 + §4C + §6 + §8 + §9 + §10; comparison §2 + §4 + §5
B	Day window held at 3 hours (9am – 12pm) to protect the night product. Extension parked as upside lever.	v2 memo §4C; comparison §5
C	Night batch cadence locked at 20 min with the existing photo dwell phase. The user-proposed overlap concept turned out to already be in the v2 design.	v2 memo §5 (no change needed beyond annotation)
D	10-min optional LED-field dwell added on the night exit beat. No gondola throughput impact; F&B uplifted by ~30%.	v2 memo §5 (new row) + §8 (F&B); comparison §2 + §8
E	25-pax commercial cap repositioned as a +21% effective-loading uplift from LED canvas demand, not a hardware re-rating.	v2 memo §4B (new section); comparison §4
F	AED 8 M balloon line resolved: it is the relocation cost of the Dubai Balloon (Atlantis → Saadiyat). The AED ~7 M delta from Hero's AED 15 M original envelope (approvals, GCAA certification, permits) is absorbed by Abu Dhabi as project-host concession.	Comparison §6 (callout updated); v2 memo Appendix A (new Slide 6 footnote row)
G	Operating buffer sensitivity made explicit. The Base Case 58 % load × 250 days is repositioned as the cautious corner of the realistic operating envelope — Hero's original 2025 proposal underwrote 70 % load on ~310 effective days for this site (page 9). Returns scale: every 7-pt load uplift ≈ +5–6 pts IRR; every +50 days ≈ +10 pts IRR.	v2 memo §11 (new section with two tables + 2×2 matrix); deck Slide 7 (new single-line callout); pitch-pdf.html sensitivity callout expanded

Appendix A — Original proposal: full content extract

For reference, the complete content of the original 19-page Hero Experiences proposal (archive/ADB_at_Saadiyat_Technical_Proposal.pdf), organised by section.

A.1 Executive Summary (page 3)

The Helium Tethered Balloon Experience is a proven, premium attraction offering guests a serene 10-minute ascent up to approximately 300 m for an unforgettable 360° view. Successfully launched and operated as The Dubai Balloon at Atlantis, The Palm. Hero Experiences Group invites a co-investor to fund CAPEX and provide the site, while Hero delivers complete operational management. Returns are distributed through a long-term revenue-share agreement. The fully certified system is ready for relocation; the project can be activated within months.

A.2 Experience Overview (page 5)

Signature cultural attraction. ~10-minute ascent to ~300 m above sea level, 360° aerial view of Saadiyat Island. Uninterrupted panoramas of Louvre Abu Dhabi, Zayed National Museum, and the future Guggenheim Abu Dhabi. Premium, family-friendly, fully accessible.

"Each flight cycle will last approximately ten minutes, including embarkation and disembarkation, allowing for five flights per hour throughout a ten-hour operating day. With a twelve-guest capacity per flight, the attraction will accommodate around 600 guests per day. Across a full operating year (average 30 days per month), this equates to approximately 216,000 guests annually, or roughly 219,000 guests on a 365-day schedule."

A.3 Specifications (page 6)

Component	Specification
Total height of system	34 m (111 ft)
Envelope diameter	22.46 m (72 ft)
Envelope volume	6,200 m ³ (220,000 ft ³)
Nominal lift	4,800 kg (10,560 lbs)
Helium loss	<70 m ³ /month
Useful envelope pressure	up to 900 Pa
Crew	2 pilots
Passenger capacity	30 passengers
Gondola material	composite + aluminum
Gondola exterior diameter	5.80 m (19 ft)
Gondola floor area	13 m ² (140 ft ²)
Gondola weight	850 kg (1,870 lbs)
Tether diameter	22 mm
Tether resistance	45 tons (99,000 lbs)
Tether useful length	up to 300 m (984 ft)
Winch house dimensions	4 × 2.2 × 1.5 m
Winch house weight	6 tons
Winch power	45 kW
Ascent speed	~50 m/min (164 ft/min)
Descent speed	~40 m/min (131 ft/min)

A.4 Highlights (page 7)

- The premier 360° observatory in Abu Dhabi
- Customisable flight times for private bookings — VIP guests, proposals, engagements, exclusive photography sessions
- Sunrise, sunset, and night flights with ambient lighting and optional onboard music or narration
- Supports sustainable, low-impact infrastructure (tethered balloon = smaller footprint)
- Panoramic views of Saadiyat Island: Louvre, Zayed NM, future Guggenheim
- Private charter options for special occasions and media shoots
- Combo ticketing opportunities with Louvre Abu Dhabi, museums, resorts, Saadiyat hospitality partners

A.5 Revenue Potential (page 9)

Field	Value
Experience type	Tethered helium hot air balloon
Average load	12 guests per flight
Flight frequency	5 flights/hour × 10 hours/day = 600 guests/day max
Operating days	365 days per year
Seasonality	6 high, 3 shoulder, 3 low months
Weather impact	15% flight cancellations annually
Load factor	70% capacity utilisation
Effective throughput	$600 \times 0.85 \times 0.70 = 357$ guests/day (~128,520/year)
Ticket — Adult (80%)	AED 195
Ticket — Child (20%)	AED 125
Ticket — Express (10%)	AED 295
Weighted average	~AED 192.4 per guest
Year 1 revenue	AED 24.7 M
YoY growth	+5%
Payback structure	10 years

A.6 Investment Structure (page 10)

Co-investment partnership between project investor (or landholding entity) and Hero Experiences Group.

Investor finances CAPEX:

- Relocation, transport, reassembly of the tethered helium balloon system
- Site preparation, foundations, utilities (power and minor infrastructure)
- Basic guest facilities (ticketing kiosk, shaded waiting area, minimal landscaping)
- Working capital for launch marketing and pre-opening readiness
- Land parcel within Saadiyat Island (proposed: 24°31'55"N 54°24'01"E)

Hero Experiences Group delivers:

- Full end-to-end operations (staffing, training, safety management, guest services, maintenance)
- Ticketing, pricing, yield strategy (OTAs, hotel concierges, tour operators)
- Marketing, branding, PR campaigns
- Helium supply and safety certification (Civil Aviation compliance, insurance)

A.7 Revenue Share Framework (page 11) ★ Critical

Reproduced verbatim from the original proposal:

Field	Value
CAPEX (Investor, one-time)	AED 15,000,000 (balloon, inflation system, deck, tether, branding)
OPEX (Hero input)	AED 600,000 / month = AED 7,200,000 / year
VAT	5% (Government levy)
Partner / Authority	12% of net-of-VAT (shared operational revenue)
Operator (Hero Experiences)	83% of gross, after VAT (5%) and Partner share
Investor Retained (10-yr forecast, including 5% YoY growth)	AED 35.4 M

A.8 Why Saadiyat, Why Now (pages 13–16)

- Saadiyat is 2,700 ha master-planned cultural-and-leisure island; world-class institutions + luxury hospitality + beaches + conservation nature
- 2024: 10% YoY visitor growth across hotels and museum venues; ~74% hotel occupancy; +14% ADR YoY
- Aligned with Abu Dhabi DCT "Tourism Strategy 2030": 39.3 M annual visitors, AED 90 B national economy contribution
- Multiple major museum openings (Zayed NM December 2025) — heightened visibility and global appeal
- Demand rising not plateauing; cultural district in transformation; emergent not saturated — opportunity to own landmark status
- Differentiation: balloon adds vertical vantage point; museums + resorts + beaches mostly ground-level
- Stay-and-explore profile: arrive early for balloon → museum → sunset resort/beach → cross-sell ecosystem
- First-mover brand advantage: position balloon as signature icon rather than late-entry amenity

A.9 Why Partner With Hero Experiences Group (page 17)

- GCC's leading operator of premium aerial and cultural attractions
- Only company in the region with proven expertise across both helium tethered balloons and hot air balloon operations
- Designed, launched, and operated the UAE's first permanent helium balloon attraction — 250,000+ safe passenger flights, flawless safety and compliance record
- Hero Balloon Flights brand — one of the world's most recognised hot air balloon companies, GCAA-certified
- Turn-key operational model: certification, staffing, ticketing, marketing, maintenance — all in-house
- Decade of aviation expertise, award-winning brands, trusted reputation with government tourism authorities

A.10 Closing — A Defining Opportunity for Abu Dhabi (page 18)

"We are offering Abu Dhabi the first right of opportunity to secure a proven, world-class attraction... The system is fully built, certified, and ready to be relocated, requiring only land allocation and capital investment to bring it to life once more. Saadiyat Island represents that stage. From above, guests will see the story of the UAE's creativity and progress unfold beneath them: Louvre Abu Dhabi, Zayed National Museum, and Guggenheim Abu Dhabi, all within one sweeping view. Hero Experiences Group brings the product, the team, and the operational expertise. We are ready to deploy, operate, and deliver immediate value."